Robert Heideman

Bicycle Technician | Workshop Lead | Skills Mentor

Wishart QLD 4122 • 0402 496 428 • robert@heideman.com.au • Driver licence • Current Blue Card

PROFILE

Frame builder and bicycle mechanic with more than 15 years of hands-on experience, starting in a Melbourne bike shop in 2009. I founded Heiden Cycle Works in 2020, where I design and build my own frames and service bikes of every kind. Since 2016 I've also been a travelling tour mechanic with Wide Open Road Cycling. I love bikes and the people who ride them. I also love teaching people how to fix them. Alongside the bikes, I have a ten-year career as a Prosthetist-Orthotist, where I've run workshops, fabricated devices by hand and mentored junior technicians. Every day in that job means explaining technical things in plain, encouraging language. I'm keen to bring my building and mechanical skills, workshop experience and passion for sharing knowledge to the PUSH! team and help young people build bikes, skills and confidence.

KEY SKILLS

- **Bicycle mechanics:** full servicing, diagnosis and repair of road, mountain, hybrid, kids' and e-bikes; complete bike builds from the frame up, including custom frame building; brakes, gears, drivetrains, wheels, hubs and bearings.
- **Safety checks and refurbishment:** inspecting and refurbishing second-hand bikes so they're safe and roadworthy, and making the most of donated and recycled parts.
- **Workshop management:** running workshops, including tool and equipment upkeep, parts inventory and ordering, workflow and workplace safety.
- **Teaching and mentoring:** mentoring junior and new technicians, and breaking complex tasks into simple, achievable steps. I'm patient, encouraging and good at building confidence.
- **Communication:** friendly, clear communicator. I've worked with clients and families of all ages, backgrounds and cultures in Australia, Europe and Cambodia.
- **Making and fabrication:** carbon frame building, design and problem-solving, including Fusion 360 CAD and 3D printing (FDM, SLA, SLS). I love inventing, building and improving things.

BICYCLE INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Founder / Frame Builder and Bicycle Technician — 2020 – Present

Heiden Cycle Works, Brisbane QLD

- Founded the business. I design and build custom bicycle frames from carbon tubes joined with 3D-printed lugs, which I design myself.
- Build, service and repair all kinds of bikes, from entry-level commuters to high-end race bikes.
- Diagnose faults, quote the work and complete repairs to a high safety standard.
- Run every part of the business, including customer service, sourcing and ordering parts, workshop and tool upkeep, and accounts.

Travelling Tour Mechanic — 2016 – Present (tours each year)

Wide Open Road Cycling

- Travel with the group on multi-day cycling tours each year and maintain every bike on the tour.
- Do daily safety checks, servicing and roadside repairs from a mobile workshop, often with limited tools and parts.
- Friendly, helpful point of contact for riders of all abilities, keeping them safe and riding.

Bicycle Mechanic — 2009 – 2015

The Ride Cycles, Kew VIC

- Workshop mechanic in a busy retail bike shop: servicing, repairs, new bike builds and customer service.

Volunteer Mechanic – Great Victorian Bike Ride — 2008 – 2015

Warrandyte High School, VIC

- Registered mechanic for the school's student team over eight years, keeping students' bikes running on a multi-day ride.
- Worked alongside students and teachers, keeping young riders safe and on the road.

Volunteer Mechanic and Support Crew – Lesa Ashford — 2023

Solo world-record attempt: first and fastest woman to cycle around Australia

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE – PROSTHETICS AND ORTHOTICS

Ten years as a Prosthetist-Orthotist and technician in Australia, Sweden and Norway, building custom devices by hand.

Senior Orthotist Jan 2026 – Sep 2026
Ability Made

- Senior orthotic role delivering custom orthoses made with digital scanning and design.

Senior Prosthetist/Orthotist May 2025 – Mar 2026
Princess Alexandra Hospital, Woolloongabba QLD

- Manage complex inpatient and outpatient cases as part of a multidisciplinary team, and lead quality assurance projects.

Senior Orthotic Technician and Head of Digital Design Jan 2024 – Present
Queensland Orthotic Lab, Capalaba QLD

- Hands-on fabrication in a busy production workshop. I mentor and train junior and new technicians.
- Introduced 3D scanning, modelling and printing into the lab's manufacturing process.

Senior Clinical Orthotist and Technician Oct 2018 – Mar 2023
Orthotic Motion Pty Ltd, Geelong VIC

Prosthetist-Orthotist and Technician Aug 2017 – Aug 2018
Drevelin Ortopedi AB, Bergen, Norway

Prosthetist-Orthotist and Technician Feb 2016 – Aug 2017
Optopedia Ortopediteknisk AS, Stockholm, Sweden

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Bachelor of Health Science / Master of Clinical Prosthetics and Orthotics 2012 – 2015
La Trobe University, Bundoora VIC

Cultural Exchange Program Jan 2014 – Jul 2014
Jönköping University, Sweden

- **Professional development:** founding member of the Digital Limb Collective; participant at the 2016 ISPO European Congress.

COMMUNITY AND VOLUNTEERING

- Veterans International Cambodia, Phnom Penh (2015): volunteered building and fitting low-cost prostheses with limited resources.
- Regular volunteer at Edgar's Mission animal sanctuary, Lancefield VIC.
- Oxfam Trailwalker, Taupō NZ (2013): our team raised $15,000.
- Relay For Life participant (2009–2012); Australian Red Cross door-knock appeal volunteer (2009–2013).

OTHER INFORMATION

- **Screening checks:** current Queensland Blue Card (held a Working with Children Check for 10+ years) and current NDIS Worker Screening Check (Yellow Card).
- **Languages:** English (native), Swedish and Norwegian (proficient).
- **Computer skills:** Microsoft Word, Excel, Outlook and PowerPoint; Fusion 360; HTML and CSS.
- **Interests:** road, mountain, track and triathlon cycling. I've completed Ironman Melbourne, the 3 Peaks Challenge and the Otway Odyssey. I also enjoy surfing, skiing and camping.

REFERENCES

Clare Holdsworth
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